

Nunavut Kindergarten–Grade 6 Curriculum Orientation Guide

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FOREWORD

"*Schooling in Nunavut should provide support to students in all areas of their development so that they can achieve personal goals, become well-equipped to contribute and serve their families and communities, demonstrate leadership and healthy attitudes, and be able to actively participate and contribute as Nunavut takes on new roles in the global community.*"[1]

Inuit Qaujimajatuqangit Education Framework for Nunavut Curriculum

To achieve the vision for education in Nunavut as presented in the *Inuit Qaujimajatuqangit Education Framework for Nunavut Curriculum* (2007), it is imperative that the curriculum used in schools be reflective of and responsive to the students, families, and communities across the territory. It is designed to build on students' learning year after year, while meeting their individual needs and investing in their areas of strength and their interests. The made-in-Nunavut curriculum promotes integrated and holistic learning experiences and encourages continuous learning that can be transferred across contexts. Language considerations are woven through the fabric of every subject area, encouraging students to call upon and strengthen their Inuktut language skills and to apply Inuit knowledge and perspectives to what they are learning every day.

To be an effective educator requires a strong understanding of the curriculum you are teaching. This guide aims to assist the educational community in navigating the new made-in-Nunavut curriculum; understanding its purpose and goals; and learning how to implement it in all subject areas. The guide outlines the framework that shapes the curriculum to give readers insight into how the new curriculum was intentionally built for use in Nunavut schools. Each section of the *Curriculum Orientation Guide* also includes guiding questions and suggested resources to provide opportunities for discussion, collaboration, and ongoing professional learning and development. Implementing a new curriculum requires patience, open-mindedness, and confidence in the material. This guide will help educators learn how to plan and assess using the new curriculum and how to create learning environments and experiences that enable students to achieve their learning goals.

The *Curriculum Orientation Guide* provides a common starting point for all educators across the territory to explore the new made-in-Nunavut curriculum and gain a shared understanding of how the new curriculum can support student learning across all areas of development. Working in collaboration with support staff, parents/guardians, and the community will help to ensure the successful implementation of the new curriculum and a strong future for education in Nunavut.

INTRODUCTION

The Department of Education initiated the development of the Kindergarten–Grade 6 made-in-Nunavut curriculum in 2018. The purpose of a made-in-Nunavut curriculum is to ensure that what students are learning in Nunavut schools is reflective of and applicable to the lived experiences and realities of Nunavummiut.

Prior to the creation of this new curriculum, elementary teachers used a combination of Nunavut-created curriculum and resources and those adapted or adopted from other Canadian jurisdictions. The *Inuit Qaujimajatuqangit Education Framework for Nunavut Curriculum* outlined the four strands that organized the Nunavut curriculum (now referred to as foundations); however, within those strands, teachers based their planning and instruction on curricula and resources that used a variety of structures and formats and that were written from a range of different perspectives.

The made-in-Nunavut curriculum aims to provide a cohesive collection of curricula with a common vision and design that centres Inuit language and culture and supports learning experiences that are meaningful and relevant for students in Nunavut. The curriculum is grounded in the Inuit Qaujimajatuqangit (IQ) principles, and it builds on and continues the work of past and current Nunavut educators. It is guided by the *Inuit Qaujimajatuqangit Education Framework for Nunavut Curriculum*, *Inuuqatigiit: The Curriculum from the Inuit Perspective*, and other documents developed in the territory. The made-in-Nunavut curriculum also seeks to align with curricula in other Canadian jurisdictions to ensure that students are prepared for future opportunities in Nunavut and beyond.

How to use this guide

The aim of this guide is to support educators, learning coaches, and administrators with the implementation of the Kindergarten–Grade 6 made-in-Nunavut curriculum. It will provide essential background information about the developmental process and the pedagogical approaches that shape the curriculum. It will also provide a comprehensive overview of the curriculum framework and the structure and organization of the curriculum documents.

This guide can be used by individuals or school teams, but it can also be used as a resource for professional development and training sessions. Educators are encouraged to work through the document section by section, taking time to pause and discuss or reflect on their understanding, implications for their practice, and questions they may still have.

There are a series of **Guiding Questions** present throughout the document that mirror the Guiding Questions in the new curriculum. Guiding Questions are open-ended and designed to encourage deeper, more critical thinking about a concept or an area of inquiry.

The Guiding Questions in this document can be used to activate prior knowledge, to generate discussion, or to guide individual reflection. They can also be used to spark further reading and investigation.

In addition, each section lists suggestions for **resources for further reading and viewing**. This document is a starting point for understanding and preparing for implementing the new curriculum across subject areas. The resources listed in these sections can be used to support ongoing professional learning for teams and individuals. Educators can return to these lists of resources as needed throughout the curriculum implementation process.

What is curriculum?

GUIDING QUESTION
What is your experience with curriculum? What is the relationship between curriculum, planning, and assessment?

The term *curriculum* can be defined and understood in many different ways. The Department of Education views curriculum at the Kindergarten–Grade 6 level as a document that outlines what students acquire and learn and how they might acquire and learn the knowledge, skills, understandings, values, and attitudes at each grade level, in each subject area. In other words, curriculum is a collection of documents in each subject area that establishes and demonstrates the sequence and the progression of learning over time.

In Nunavut, the curriculum is written for educators, and it lays the foundation for consistent and equitable education for students across the territory. The curriculum is used as a starting point to plan and develop lessons and choose appropriate resources for instruction. It is also used as a basis for assessing student learning across each grade level.

INUIT QAUJIMAJATUQANGIT AND THE NEW CURRICULUM

GUIDING QUESTION
How does Inuit Qaujimajatuqangit (IQ) inform your current teaching practice?

Inuit Qaujimajatuqangit (IQ), or "that which Inuit have always known to be true," is the foundation for social-emotional, spiritual, mental, and physical well-being. When learning is embedded in culture, it supports a sense of identity, a feeling of belonging, and a connection to those around us.[2] The principles of IQ are:

- *Inuuqatigiitsiarniq*: respecting others, relationships, and caring for people.
- *Tunnganarniq*: fostering good spirits by being open, welcoming, and inclusive.
- *Pijitsirniq*: serving and providing for family and/or community.
- *Aajiiqatigiingniq*: decision-making through discussion and consensus.
- *Pilimmaksarniq/pijariuqsarniq*: development of skills through observation, mentoring, practice, and effort
- *Piliriqatigiingniq/ikajuqtigiingniq*: working together for a common cause.
- *Qanuqtuurunnarniq*: being innovative and resourceful.
- *Avatimik kamattiarniq*: respect and care for the land, animals, and environment.[3]

The IQ principles form the foundation of the new made-in-Nunavut curriculum. They are not specific to one grade or subject area but instead help to support an integrated, cross-curricular approach to education that encourages students to make meaningful connections between what they are learning in the classroom and their lives outside of it. The IQ principles incorporate the knowledge, skills, understandings, and attitudes students will need to engage actively with the world around them, build strong relationships, and contribute to their communities in ways that reflect Inuit culture and ways of knowing. The Kindergarten–Grade 6 made-in-Nunavut curriculum aims both to embed the IQ principles within the expectations for learning and to create space within the curriculum for students to engage with IQ in ways that are meaningful to them.

Inuit Qaujimajatuqangit and global competencies

The IQ principles provide the essential groundwork for the new curriculum in a similar way that global competencies or other frameworks structure curricula across Canada and around the world. According to the Council of Ministers of Education Canada (CMEC), global competencies are "an overarching set of attitudes, skills, knowledge, and values that are interdependent, interdisciplinary, and can be leveraged in a variety of situations both locally and globally. They provide learners with the abilities to meet the shifting and ongoing demands of life, work, and learning; to be active and responsive in their communities; to understand diverse perspectives; and to act on issues of global significance."[4]

CMEC identifies six global competencies:

1. Critical thinking and problem-solving
2. Innovation, creativity, and entrepreneurship
3. Learning to learn, self-awareness, and self-direction
4. Collaboration
5. Communication
6. Global citizenship and sustainability

CMEC encourages provinces and territories across Canada to integrate global competencies into their curricula and notes the alignment amongst the different frameworks currently being used across jurisdictions, including the IQ principles. However, CMEC also notes that these competencies will continue to evolve as provinces and territories respond to the needs and priorities of their communities. They also note that the framework of global competencies will be "shaped by and reflective of Indigenous knowledge, perspective, languages and histories."[5] Drawing on the IQ principles as the basis for the new curriculum in Nunavut will help to ensure that Inuit language, culture, values, and teachings remain at the core of student learning.

Resources for further reading and viewing

- Northwest Territories Education, Culture and Employment. *Inuuqatigiit: The Curriculum from the Inuit Perspective*. 1996.

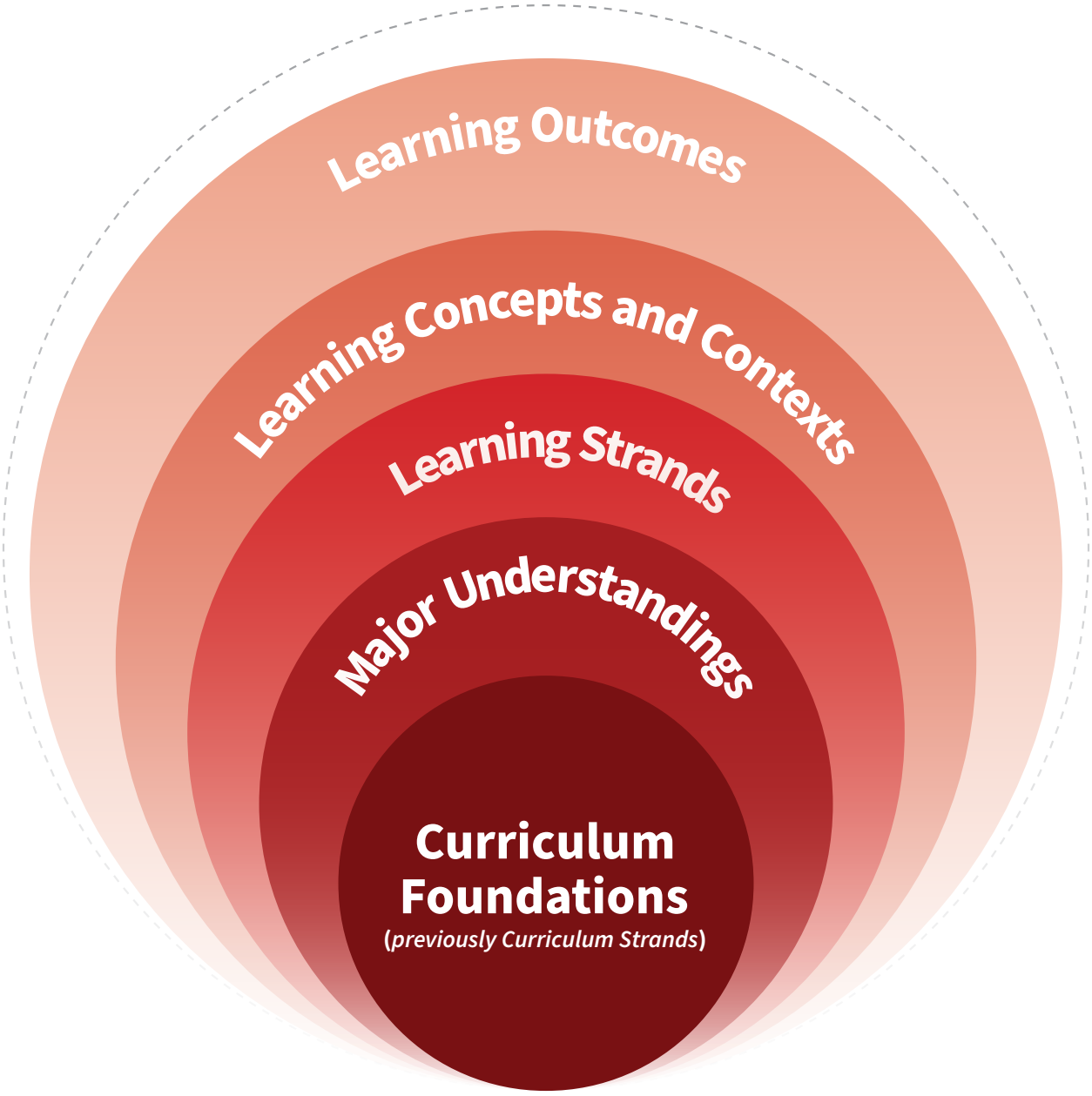
- Nunavut Department of Education. *Inuit Qaujimajatuqangit Education Framework for Nunavut Curriculum*. 2007. https://www.gov.nu.ca/sites/default/files/files/Inuit%20Qaujimajatuqangit%20ENG.pdf.

NAVIGATING THE MADE-IN-NUNAVUT CURRICULUM

The made-in-Nunavut curriculum is designed to provide a rich and inclusive educational experience for students across the territory. It focuses on exploring key concepts across areas of learning, promoting critical thinking, and valuing and preserving Inuit language and culture. The goal is to foster comprehensive and culturally responsive learning experiences for students that nurture social-emotional, spiritual, mental, and physical well-being, a sense of cultural identity and belonging, and a strong academic foundation.

This section provides an overview of the structure and organization of the made-in-Nunavut curriculum to help educators understand the purpose of each element and how they can be used to inform planning, instruction, and assessment. This section reflects the layout of the curriculum, starting with a broader framework that shapes the curriculum across subject areas and ending with the Learning Outcomes and additional information specific to each grade level. Each element of this curriculum is designed to inform and support the other elements to ensure students are not only able to understand what they are learning at a deeper level but also why they are learning it and how it connects to other areas of learning and to their lives outside the classroom.

The curriculum framework



In order to develop a new Nunavut curriculum that is both relevant and comprehensive, it was important to create a curriculum framework that reflects the unique culture and context in which students in Nunavut live and learn. Beginning with a clear framework ensures that the curriculum and subsequent resources in all subject areas are aligned and that all curricula developed now and in the future are rooted in Inuit values and worldview.

A concept-based approach to curriculum development

It is imperative that made-in-Nunavut curricula grounded in Inuit Qaujimajatuqangit and Inuit pedagogy be holistic, promote critical thinking, and encourage the transfer of learning across contexts. A concept-based approach to curriculum development focuses on identifying and exploring the relationships between the knowledge, skills, and understandings in different areas of learning in order to better understand the broader structures, patterns, and systems that exist in our world. Taking a concept-based approach to designing the made-in-Nunavut curriculum encourages students to develop a deeper and richer understanding of key concepts within and across subject areas and allows them to see purpose and value in what they are learning.[6]

A concept-based approach aligns with the holistic and interconnected nature of learning. By exploring concepts through the lens of Inuit language and culture, students develop a comprehensive understanding of key ideas, fostering deep engagement and highlighting their relevance in students' lives and communities. Furthermore, a concept-based approach nurtures critical thinking, problem-solving, and transferable skills. By focusing on overarching concepts, students develop a broader understanding of how knowledge and skills apply across diverse contexts. They learn to analyze, synthesize, and transfer their understanding to real-world situations, equipping them with the ability to navigate complexities and make informed decisions.

A concept-based approach to curriculum development offers distinct advantages over a content-based approach, particularly in the unique context of education in Nunavut. Instead of focusing solely on delivering subject-specific knowledge, a concept-based approach emphasizes the development of overarching concepts that integrate and connect knowledge across different subject areas. As teachers explore the new curriculum they will see explicit connections between knowledge, skills, and understandings in different areas of learning. For example, concepts related to healthy relationships and effective communication are essential parts of the *Physical Education, Health, and Wellness Curriculum*. However, these concepts are also explored from different perspectives in the Language Arts curricula and *Social Studies Curriculum*. Students' relationship to and stewardship of the land is integral to the *Social Studies Curriculum* and the *Science Curriculum* but is also integrated into the *Physical Education, Health, and Wellness Curriculum* and *Arts Education Curriculum* as well. Structuring this curriculum in this way allows teachers to plan cross-curricular learning experiences that are rooted in IQ and are relevant and meaningful for students.

By adopting a concept-based approach, the made-in-Nunavut curriculum supports a scaffolded progression of learning. Students establish a solid foundation of concepts which are continuously expanded upon as they advance through grades. This approach enables cumulative learning over time, reinforcing understanding and facilitating connections and applications across subject areas. The integration of IQ principles ensures that the curriculum is aligned with the values, practices, and traditions of Nunavummiut, fostering a deep connection to students' cultural identity and instilling pride and ownership in their learning.

Curriculum Foundations and subject areas

Curriculum Foundations	Subject area(s)
 **Nunavusiutit**	• Social Studies
 **Iqqaqqaukkaringniq**	• Mathematics • Science
 **Uqausiliriniq**	• Inuktut 1st Language Enhanced (IL1e) • Inuktut 1st Language (IL1) • Inuktut 2nd Language (IL2) • English 1st Language (EL1) • English 2nd Language (EL2) • Arts Education
 **Aulajaaqtut**	• Physical Education, Health, and Wellness

The *Inuit Qaujimajatuqangit Education Framework for Nunavut Curriculum* outlines four Curriculum Strands: *Nunavusiutit*, *Iqqaqqaukkaringniq*, *Uqausiliriniq*, and *Aulajaaqtut*. According to the document, the strands "are generic in nature, transcend subject-specific content areas, and result in the application and transfer of specific learning to new contexts and situations. This approach to learning is designed to focus on the development of complex intellectual (metacognitive) skills and lead students to transformational ways of thinking and processing. This type of approach helps students to understand the connections between various learnings and the strategies that lead to successful application of learning in new contexts."[7] The new curriculum framework maintains this organization, using the term **Curriculum Foundations** in place of Curriculum Strands. These Curriculum Foundations, along with the IQ principles, create the foundation of the framework and are at the core of the development of curriculum in all subject areas.

Uqausiliriniq Curriculum Foundation

The Uqausiliriniq Curriculum Foundation focuses on relationships in communication and language development, creative and artistic expression, and reflective and critical thinking. The principles of the Uqausiliriniq Curriculum Foundation include *inuuqatiqarunnaqsivallianiq* (building relationships), *ikpigusugunnarniq inuuqatiminik* (respecting others), *isumatunikkut tukisiniarniq* (thinking creatively and seeking to understand), and *pivaalliinilukłuni sivuniksaqattiarnirmut* (improving on the present and building strength for the future). The subject areas within the Uqausiliriniq Curriculum Foundation include Inuktut 1st Language Enhanced (IL1e), Inuktut 1st Language (IL1), Inuktut 2nd Language (IL2), English 1st Language (EL1), English 2nd Language (EL2), and Arts Education.



Inuktut 1st Language Enhanced Curriculum (IL1e)

The *IL1e* was researched, written, and reviewed by a working group of educational and Inuktut-language experts from across Nunavut. The working group gave careful consideration to creating a curriculum that is accessible, balanced, and reflective of the unique nature of Inuktut as a language and the culture of Nunavut. The *IL1e* is designed to be used with students whose first language is Inuktut and who have a strong level of fluency in Inuktut. Schools that implement this curriculum follow the Qulliq model of language instruction, which is designed for communities or cohorts of students with strong Inuktut first-language skills and teaches students to communicate in Inuktut first, while gradually introducing English as a second language. *IL1e* also uses the Dual Language Model of instruction in the Inuit language stream.



Inuktut 1st Language Curriculum (IL1)

The *IL1* is a language revitalization curriculum for students who need to (re)learn and strengthen their Inuktut skills. This model provides students with as much Inuktut instruction throughout the day as possible and extends their Inuktut language and literacy skills across multiple subject areas. Schools that implement this curriculum follow the Immersion Model of language instruction which is designed for communities that have experienced significant language loss with a focus to reverse language loss and produce strong bilingual graduates.



Inuktut 2nd Language Curriculum (IL2)

The *IL2* was also researched, written, and reviewed by a working group of educational and Inuktut-language experts from across Nunavut. The *IL2* outlines grade-level Learning Outcomes for Inuktut second-language students. The *IL2* is designed to be used with students whose first language is a language other than Inuktut. The *IL2* provides students with one period of Inuktut learning each day, allowing their Inuktut-language skills to grow each year. Schools that implement this curriculum follow the Dual-Language Model of language instruction in the Non-Inuit Language Stream. This Language of Instruction model is designed for communities that have a large base of both strong Inuktut first-language speakers and English first-language speakers.



English 1st Language Curriculum (EL1)

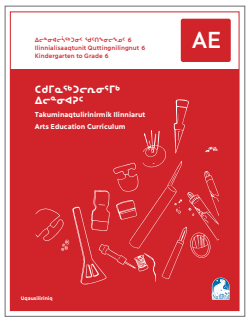
The *EL1* provides opportunities for students to engage with language and literacy learning and is designed to be used with students whose first language is English. Students will develop the skills, knowledge, and understandings needed to become effective communicators; develop and express their own ideas; and think deeply about the ideas and perspectives of others.

The *EL1* will encourage students to make connections and apply language and literacy skills to new contexts and situations. Schools that implement this curriculum follow the Dual Language Model of languages instruction in the Non-Inuit Language Stream.



English 2nd Language Curriculum (EL2)

The *EL2* is designed for students whose first language is a language other than English. Students entering Kindergarten will have varying knowledge of English depending on the level of exposure within their households and communities. The curriculum aims to engage students in authentic and relevant language-learning experiences that will help them to become independent users of English, develop skills for further knowledge seeking, and build relationships in a wider language community. Schools that implement this curriculum follow the Qulliq Model of language instruction and support Inuktut as the main language of instruction while supporting students' acquisition of English as a second language.

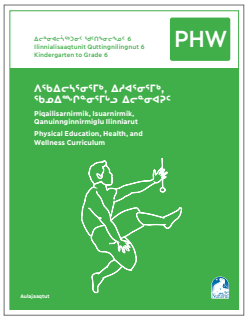


Arts Education Curriculum

The *Arts Education Curriculum* is designed to give students opportunities to develop their own creative processes while also exploring the views, perspectives, and experiences of others. Creating and responding to art will help foster students' curiosity and critical and creative thinking. It will also help them to develop their identity and work toward a sense of well-being. This curriculum aims to provide a holistic approach to Arts Education that will encourage students to make cross-curricular connections and see the role art can play in their lives outside of the classroom.

Aulajaaqtut Curriculum Foundation

The Aulajaaqtut Curriculum Foundation focuses on wellness, safety, and one's place in society. The principles of the Aulajaaqtut Curriculum Foundation include *saimaniq* (harmony), *pijaksaqarniq* (responsibility), *qinuinniq* (discipline), and *silatuniq* (wisdom). Physical Education, Health, and Wellness is the subject area in the Aulajaaqtut Curriculum Foundation in Kindergarten–Grade 6.

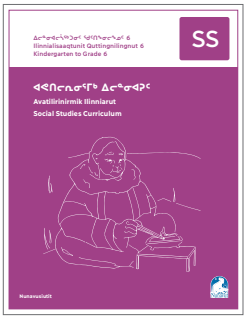


Physical Education, Health, and Wellness Curriculum

The *Physical Education, Health, and Wellness Curriculum* is designed to help students develop the knowledge, skills, and understandings they need to live a healthy and active life. Students will discover the physical, mental, and emotional benefits of daily physical activity and be empowered to make choices that support their health and wellness. The curriculum will address issues and challenges students in Nunavut face and nurture the development of their self-concept and resilience. Students will develop strategies to recognize and regulate their emotions and learn to build caring, healthy relationships. They will cultivate their sense of self and develop an appreciation for where they come from and how the land contributes to their health and wellness. They will also discover how maintaining their own health and wellness can help them support the health and wellness of their family, their community, and beyond.

Nunavusiutit Curriculum Foundation

Through the Nunavusiutit Curriculum Foundation, students learn about the people and the land of Nunavut, the experiences of Nunavummiut in the past and present, and Nunavut's critical links to national, circumpolar, and global issues. The principles of the Nunavusiutit Curriculum Foundation focus on and draw from heritage, culture, history, geography, environmental science, civics, economics, current events, and worldviews. These principles include *uqaujjusiaminik malingniq* (discipline and learning from mistakes), *ikpingnianiqattiarniq* (having the right attitude), *saimaniup pimmariuninga* (the importance of harmony), *ujjirusuttiarniq* (having an awareness), *piniarnikkut ilittiniq* (learning to do), *upalungaijaqsimaniq* (having a plan), *ilagiingniq tuqłurausiit* (relationship/kinship). Social Studies is the subject area in the Nunavusiutit Curriculum Foundation in Kindergarten–Grade 6.

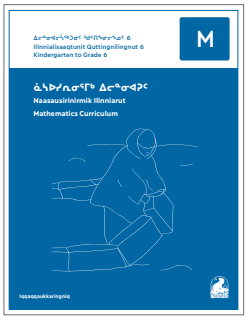


Social Studies Curriculum

The *Social Studies Curriculum* provides a framework for engaging students in inquiry-based experiences that will help them own their learning, make meaning of the world they live in, and learn to live well together. In Nunavut, social studies is a critical area of learning that involves the decisions people make to live well together on this planet. The curriculum will guide students to develop an understanding of personal and community identity; to engage with the world; and to become capable persons. Colonization has played a significant role in Nunavut's past and has created many obstacles for Inuit that continue to this day. The *Social Studies Curriculum* must serve to address this reality and provide students with tools for empowerment and reconciliation.

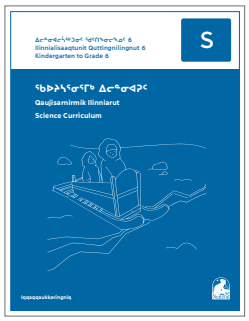
Iqqaqqaukkaringniq Curriculum Foundation

The Iqqaqqaukkaringniq Curriculum Foundation focuses on the ways in which we describe and improve our world. This includes exploring concepts related to mathematics, analytical and critical thinking, solution-seeking, innovation, technology, and practical arts. The principles of the Iqqaqqaukkaringniq Curriculum Foundation include *uqumaittunik isumaksaqsiurniq* (heavy thinking), *qaujimajumaniq* (curiosity), *uukturarniq* (experimentation), *sivuliqsiniq* (leadership), and *ilittiniq tammaqtarnikkut* (learning from mistakes). Mathematics and Science are the subject areas in the Iqqaqqaukkaringniq Curriculum Foundation.



Mathematics Curriculum

The *Mathematics Curriculum* encourages students to think critically, develop and apply tools and strategies when problem-solving, persevere through problems, and apply their understanding of mathematics to their daily life. For students to engage effectively with mathematics, they must sense value and personal relevance to the learning. The *Mathematics Curriculum* encourages exploration of mathematics in their local environment. This may include learning using familiar materials, referencing local examples, communicating and working collaboratively, and using their preferred language. Mathematical vocabulary is frequently defined, and students are encouraged to investigate and demonstrate their learning in a variety of ways, including on the land, through art, and through personally relevant topics.



Science Curriculum

The *Science Curriculum* nurtures exploration, curiosity, problem-solving, and sharing of traditional knowledge as students build their understanding of the world and universe. When students understand the scientific structures of the physical and natural world, it helps to connect them to a sense of place and encourages them to consider their impact on the world around them. Through learning science skills and knowledge, they build their understanding of how to ask questions, solve problems, make informed decisions, and innovate for the future. The *Science Curriculum* is designed using Two-Eyed Seeing, described as viewing the world through one eye using strengths of Indigenous knowledge and ways of knowing, and from the other eye with the strengths of Western knowledge and ways of knowing.[8] Using both eyes together will lead to the gift of multiple perspectives.

Major Understandings

The curriculum in each subject area begins with a set of **Major Understandings**. These are broad statements that reflect the essential principles and core ideas within a subject area that can be transferred across different areas of learning.[9] These Major Understandings anchor the curriculum in the purpose for learning in each subject area and the values of IQ. They are the overarching understandings at the heart of the subject, spanning all grades and topics. They act as a lens through which teachers can make decisions about planning, instruction, and assessment.

> **Students will develop the oral communication skills necessary to speak and interact with others and to listen and respond to texts and to others in Inuktut.**

Guiding Questions

Guiding Questions are open, exploratory, inquiry-based questions that can guide teachers and students toward deeper thinking on curriculum concepts. Each curriculum document includes Guiding Questions that aim to generate links between the Major Understandings and the Learning Outcomes in each grade. These questions can help both students and educators to focus the learning, make connections to the IQ principles, and connect with their sense of place. The Guiding Questions provided in the curriculum documents may be used in daily classroom activities and discussions, as part of assessment tasks, to plan units or themes, and to inspire inquiry-based projects.

> Guiding Question: **What makes a good listener?**

Learning Strands

Learning Strands incorporate the key concepts and processes within each subject area and the relationships among them. The Learning Strands remain consistent across grades to encourage a richer exploration of how these concepts and processes work together over time. Educators can use the Learning Strands to understand what students may have learned in a subject area in previous grades and what they will be learning in the future. This can help educators address gaps in student learning and help students understand how what they are currently learning will connect to what they will learn in the future.

Examples of Learning Strands in the made-in-Nunavut curriculum include:

- *IL1*: Oral Communication, Reading, and Writing
- *Physical Education, Health, and Wellness*: Physical Literacy, Healthy Living, and Social Emotional Wellness
- *Social Studies*: Community, Stories, and The Land

KINDERGARTEN: ORAL COMMUNICATION

Learning Concepts and Contexts

Learning Concepts and Contexts outline the constructs, processes, and patterns within each Learning Strand. These concepts or contexts provide a structure through which students can organize and connect the Learning Outcomes. Helping students make connections between the knowledge and skills they are acquiring within a subject area can make the learning more purposeful. It can also help students deepen their understanding of what they are learning and apply their learning across different contexts.

Learning Concept **Students will learn about:**
1. Listening to understand

Learning Outcomes

Learning Outcomes define the key knowledge, skills, and understandings students will develop at each grade level. They are the building blocks that support deep conceptual understanding within an area of learning. The Learning Outcomes in each subject area are designed to build and progress across grade levels. As students move from year to year, the expectations within the Learning Outcomes become more complex and encourage higher-level thinking skills. However, encouraging this progression of learning over time also provides more time and space for students to grow and develop at their own pace and to ensure key concepts and skills are not missed or overlooked.

Developing a strong understanding of the Learning Outcomes will help educators set expectations for learning that are relevant and developmentally appropriate for students at each grade level. These Learning Outcomes also provide the basis for accurate and equitable assessment of student learning across the territory.

Educators should use the Learning Outcomes, as well as the Learning Concepts and Contexts, Learning Strands, and Major Understandings to inform their planning and teaching in the classroom. Learning experiences should be responsive and reflective of the students and families within each community. Using the elements of the curriculum to guide the expectations and progression of learning will help to maintain consistency across Nunavut schools while ensuring that learning remains grounded in Inuit language, culture, and lived experiences of Nunavummiut.

Learning Outcome **By the end of Kindergarten, students will:**
K.OC.1.1 **Demonstrate understanding of modelled sounds, vocabulary, and language patterns in the classroom.**

Additional information

Notice if the student:

- Follows simple directions, such as:
  - "Line up in a straight line."
  - "Stand up."
  - "Come over here."

Additional notes

Some students require a lot of practice and repetition before they can follow simple directions. For many students, the classroom will be the first structured environment they experience, and they will learn what is expected of them as they go.

"Notice if the student"

Within the Learning Outcomes in each curriculum document, there is a subsection called **"Notice if the student"** which outlines examples of possible behaviours or indicators of how students may demonstrate their learning. This can include saying, doing, or representing. The behaviours described in this section can be used to guide planning and instruction or support individual or whole-class intervention. They can also be used to inform or build criteria for assessment.

The "Notice ifs" are not an exhaustive list of examples, and teachers may encounter many other indicators of student understanding. They can also help educators to develop a better understanding of what is expected within each Learning Outcome. These should be used as a jumping off point to help focus educators' observation and documentation of student learning in each subject area.

Additional notes

The **Additional notes** section provides more information about each Learning Outcome. This includes definitions of key vocabulary or terms or examples to provide additional clarification. These additional notes also refer educators to other resources for more information.

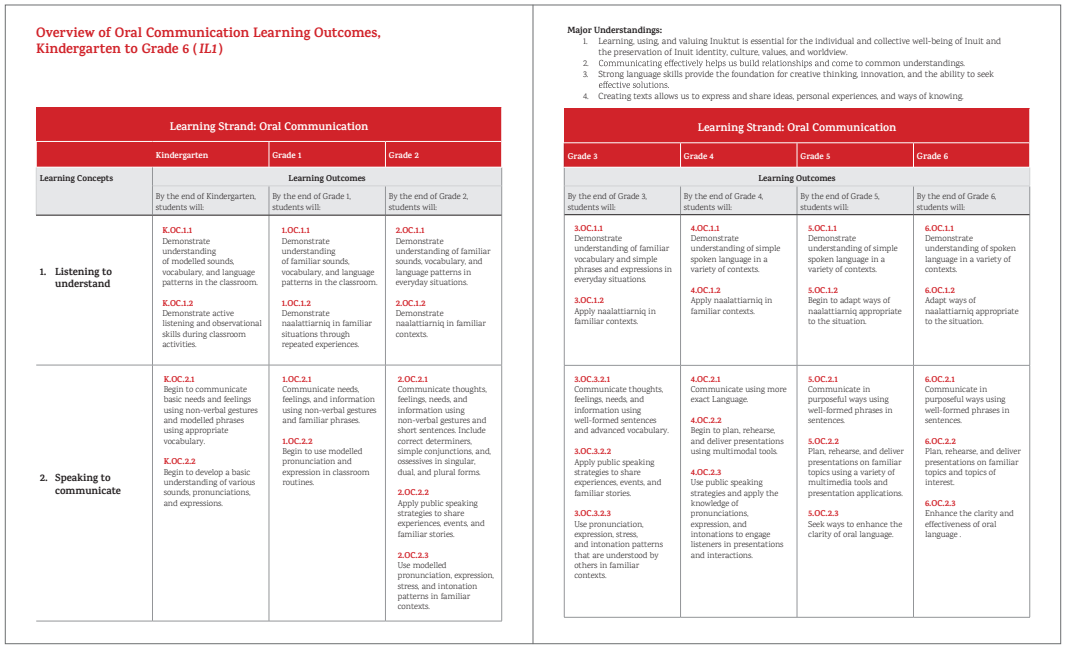
Reproducibles and additional resources

Each Kindergarten–Grade 6 made-in-Nunavut curriculum document contains reproducibles and additional resources to assist teachers with understanding, planning, and implementing the curriculum.

Please note that these resources should be used as companions to the curriculum and are not intended to be used without a full understanding of the curriculum document.

Overview of Learning Outcomes charts

These charts provide an overview of the curriculum in each subject area, including the Major Understandings, Learning Strands, Learning Concepts, Guiding Questions, and Learning Outcomes at each grade level. The overview charts can be used to provide a general understanding of a subject area and how concepts build and progress from year to year. They can also be used to view which expectations students should have achieved the year before, as a jumping off point for students to share their prior knowledge, or to recognize where to start for students who did not previously learn the material. It is also useful for teachers working with split-grade classes to see the Learning Outcomes side by side and notice connections. It is important that these charts are not used alone and that teachers refer to the full curriculum document for planning, instruction, and assessment. The full Learning Outcomes, including the "Notice if the student" and Additional notes sections, are needed to ensure students have a developed and complete understanding of each outcome.



Overview of Oral Communication Learning Outcomes, Kindergarten to Grade 6 (*IL1*)

Learning Strand: Oral Communication			
	Kindergarten	Grade 1	Grade 2
Learning Concepts	Learning Outcomes		
	By the end of Kindergarten, students will:	By the end of Grade 1, students will:	By the end of Grade 2, students will:
1. Listening to understand	**K.OC.1.1** Demonstrate understanding of modelled sounds, vocabulary, and language patterns in the classroom. **K.OC.1.2** Demonstrate active listening and observational skills during classroom activities.	**1.OC.1.1** Demonstrate understanding of familiar sounds, vocabulary, and language patterns in the classroom. **1.OC.1.2** Demonstrate naalattiarniq in familiar situations through repeated experiences.	**2.OC.1.1** Demonstrate understanding of familiar sounds, vocabulary, and language patterns in everyday situations. **2.OC.1.2** Demonstrate naalattiarniq in familiar contexts.
2. Speaking to communicate	**K.OC.2.1** Begin to communicate basic needs and feelings using non-verbal gestures and modelled phrases using appropriate vocabulary. **K.OC.2.2** Begin to develop a basic understanding of various sounds, pronunciations, and expressions.	**1.OC.2.1** Communicate needs, feelings, and information using non-verbal gestures and familiar phrases. **1.OC.2.2** Begin to use modelled pronunciation and expression in classroom routines.	**2.OC.2.1** Communicate thoughts, feelings, needs, and information using non-verbal gestures and short sentences. Include correct determiners, simple conjunctions, and, ossesives in singular, dual, and plural forms. **2.OC.2.2** Apply public speaking strategies to share experiences, events, and familiar stories. **2.OC.2.3** Use modelled pronunciation, expression, stress, and intonation patterns in familiar contexts.

Major Understandings:

1. Learning, using, and valuing Inuktut is essential for the individual and collective well-being of Inuit and the preservation of Inuit identity, culture, values, and worldview.
2. Communicating effectively helps us build relationships and come to common understandings.
3. Strong language skills provide the foundation for creative thinking, innovation, and the ability to seek effective solutions.
4. Creating texts allows us to express and share ideas, personal experiences, and ways of knowing.

Learning Strand: Oral Communication			
Grade 3	Grade 4	Grade 5	Grade 6
Learning Outcomes			
By the end of Grade 3, students will:	By the end of Grade 4, students will:	By the end of Grade 5, students will:	By the end of Grade 6, students will:
3.OC.1.1 Demonstrate understanding of familiar vocabulary and simple phrases and expressions in everyday situations. **3.OC.1.2** Apply naalattiarniq in familiar contexts.	**4.OC.1.1** Demonstrate understanding of simple spoken language in a variety of contexts. **4.OC.1.2** Apply naalattiarniq in familiar contexts.	**5.OC.1.1** Demonstrate understanding of simple spoken language in a variety of contexts. **5.OC.1.2** Begin to adapt ways of naalattiarniq appropriate to the situation.	**6.OC.1.1** Demonstrate understanding of spoken language in a variety of contexts. **6.OC.1.2** Adapt ways of naalattiarniq appropriate to the situation.
3.OC.2.1 Communicate thoughts, feelings, needs, and information using well-formed sentences and advanced vocabulary. **3.OC.2.2** Apply public speaking strategies to share experiences, events, and familiar stories. **3.OC.2.3** Use pronunciation, expression, stress, and intonation patterns that are understood by others in familiar contexts.	**4.OC.2.1** Communicate using more exact Language. **4.OC.2.2** Begin to plan, rehearse, and deliver presentations using multimodal tools. **4.OC.2.3** Use public speaking strategies and apply the knowledge of pronunciations, expression, and intonations to engage listeners in presentations and interactions.	**5.OC.2.1** Communicate in purposeful ways using well-formed phrases in sentences. **5.OC.2.2** Plan, rehearse, and deliver presentations on familiar topics using a variety of multimedia tools and presentation applications. **5.OC.2.3** Seek ways to enhance the clarity of oral language.	**6.OC.2.1** Communicate in purposeful ways using well-formed phrases in sentences. **6.OC.2.2** Plan, rehearse, and deliver presentations on familiar topics and topics of interest. **6.OC.2.3** Enhance the clarity and effectiveness of oral language .

Learning Outcomes checklists

Each curriculum document contains checklists at the end. These checklists contain the Learning Outcomes for each Learning Strand in each grade. These checklists can be used for creating year-long plans to ensure all outcomes have been considered and incorporated. Teachers may also use the checklists to track student progress; however, the checklists are not meant to be used as a substitute for tracking student assessment. The curriculum is holistic, with multiple outcomes across multiple subjects overlapping and complimenting one another. Teachers should not view an outcome as "done" for the year and should regularly be considering ways to connect new learning to previously taught concepts.

Name: _____

***IL1* LEARNING OUTCOMES CHECKLISTS: KINDERGARTEN**

Oral Communication

		✓	NOTES
K.OC.1.1	Demonstrate understanding of modelled sounds, vocabulary, and language patterns in the classroom.		
K.OC.1.2	Demonstrate active listening and observational skills during classroom activities.		
K.OC.2.1	Begin to communicate basic needs and feelings using non-verbal gestures and modelled phrases using appropriate vocabulary.		
K.OC.2.2	Begin to develop a basic understanding of various sounds, pronunciations, and expressions.		
K.OC.3.1	Demonstrate tunnganarniq and inuuqatigiitsiarniq with modelled greetings and phrases in daily routines.		
K.OC.3.2	Ask and respond to simple questions using modelled phrases and non-verbal gestures.		
K.OC.4.1	Listen to traditional stories told orally and shared through books, songs, and chants.		

Glossary

The glossary contains definitions for words found within the curriculum document. Some teachers may wish to refer to the glossary to ensure they understand the vocabulary used. The glossary is written in simple language so that teachers can share these definitions with their students.

EDUCATOR SUPPORT BINDERS

Teachers are encouraged to refer to the Educator Support Binders for each subject area for more information on planning, instruction, and assessment. The binders give examples of planning templates as well as additional support for instruction in each subject area. They also contain tips and strategies for creating a culturally responsive classroom that centres Inuit language and culture.

GUIDING QUESTION

How do your current assessment practices address language considerations? How could they be modified to provide a wider range of opportunities to demonstrate their learning?

Resources for further reading and viewing

- Erickson, Lynn, Lois Lanning, and Rachel French. *Concept-Based Curriculum and Instruction for the Thinking Classroom.* Thousand Oaks: Corwin, 2017.

- Marschall, Carla and Rachel French. *Concept-Based Inquiry in Action: Strategies to Promote Transferable Understanding.* Thousand Oaks: Corwin, 2018.

PLANNING FOR ASSESSMENT AS/FOR/OF LEARNING

GUIDING QUESTION

How does the curriculum help to inform planning, teaching, and assessment? What is your experience with assessment? What does dynamic assessment look and sound like in your school and classrooms?

Assessment refers to the strategies and tools educators use to determine what students know, what they can do, and where they may need additional support. Assessment is an essential component of effective teaching. Effective assessment is directly linked to the skills, knowledge, and understandings outlined in the curriculum and is responsive to the learning needs of each student. Educators assess students to gather information about all areas of student learning and use this information to make decisions about planning, instruction, and ways to support student learning and achievement.

According to *Ilitaunnikuliriniq: Foundation for Dynamic Assessment as Learning in Nunavut Schools* (2008), student achievement should be measured:

- Over time
- For an intended purpose
- In ways that are fair and appropriate
- In ways that take into account the IQ perspectives of the people of Nunavut

Dynamic assessment in Nunavut

"Ilitaunnikuliriniq represents the dynamic interaction of teaching, learning and assessment. Assessment should be seen as a process that improves both teaching and learning. That assessment process begins on the day students enter the classroom and teachers begin to learn about who they are, what they know, and what they want to know."[10]

The process of assessment, evaluation, and reporting in Nunavut schools is called *ilitaunnikuliriniq*. It is an approach that promotes and enhances learning for everyone, including students, educators, parents and guardians, and communities. Ilitaunnikuliriniq holds the firm belief that all students can learn and achieve their goals when given the appropriate support. This strength-based approach promotes a culture of success that values effort and provides encouragement through ongoing, personal, and descriptive feedback.

Ilitaunnikuliriniq principles guide all assessments in Nunavut schools. These principles reflect IQ principles and are supported by current evidence-based research. The assessment principles for Nunavut schools include:

- Supporting continuous learning for all students
- Showing respect for all learners
- Recognizing each student's unique talents and skills
- Emphasizing the interdependence, growth, and success of the group
- Ensuring assessment is outcome-based
- Having different purposes for assessment
- Ensuring assessment is authentic, meaningful, and builds on student strengths

It is essential that all educators in Nunavut have access to and are familiar with the foundation document *Ilitaunnikuliriniq: Foundation for Dynamic Assessment as Learning in Nunavut Schools* (2008) to support their use of the Kindergarten–Grade 6 made-in-Nunavut curriculum and to inform their assessment practices.

Using the made-in-Nunavut curriculum to support assessment

Student assessment in all subject areas must have a clear purpose and be aligned with the Learning Outcomes at each grade level. The Learning Outcomes define the key knowledge, skills, and understandings students are expected to develop during each grade level. It is crucial that assessment begins with an understanding of the Learning Outcomes and is ongoing throughout the year. Educators should provide students with multiple opportunities to demonstrate their learning related to each Learning Outcome in different ways. The information gathered through the assessment tools and strategies will help to paint a fuller picture of student achievement throughout the year and help educators to plan more targeted intervention that addresses the needs of each student.

As described previously, the "Notice if the student" section within each Learning Outcome provides examples and potential indicators of how students may demonstrate their learning. These indicators can be used for formative assessment during the learning process to provide ongoing information about student learning and development related to each Learning Outcome. Formative assessment also supports educator reflection and planning to inform and modify instructional approaches and address potential gaps in student learning. The indicators can be incorporated into learning goals so that students are involved in the learning process and begin to monitor and take responsibility for their learning.

It is important to remember that the "Notice ifs" are not exhaustive lists of the ways in which students may demonstrate their learning. These indicators are intended to be flexible and build on the strengths of each student while providing options and opportunities for students to demonstrate their learning and the development of the Learning Outcomes in various ways.

Authentic assessment

"When the process of learning becomes visible, it can become an invitation to viewers into the work that opens up collaborative possibilities."[11]

Assessment in Nunavut classrooms must be authentic and grounded in real-life experiences. Students need to be active participants in the learning process and understand what they are learning and why. The made-in-Nunavut curriculum promotes deeper understanding of key concepts within and across subject areas that allows students to see the purpose and value in what they are learning.

Rich tasks that involve project-based and experiential learning help students connect what they are learning inside the classroom to their lived experiences outside of the classroom. This ensures that assessment is relevant and developmentally and culturally appropriate. Authentic assessment should be seen as a collaborative, holistic process that focuses on what students can do in their world.[12]

Language considerations in assessment

It is critical that educators in Nunavut consider the language of instruction (LOI) and language contexts of their students when planning, teaching, and assessing. When assessing student learning, educators must consider whether students are learning in their first language and if their language skills are creating a barrier for accurate assessment in specific subject areas. For example, assessing students only through tasks involving reading and writing may limit students' ability to fully demonstrate what they have learned.

To accurately capture student learning, educators should reflect on whether the assessment tools and strategies used enable the student to demonstrate their skills, knowledge, and understanding of a concept. Educators need to be aware of how language may be impacting student learning and consider how they can adapt their tools to capture students' strengths and needs with accuracy. The Learning Outcomes in the made-in-Nunavut curriculum aim to encourage students to show their learning in many different ways and to reduce barriers students may face as their language skills are developing.

GUIDING QUESTION

How do your current assessment practices address language considerations? How could they be modified to provide a wider range of opportunities to demonstrate their learning?

Resources for further reading and viewing

- Luke, Allen. "Allen Luke: Rich Tasks." March 4, 2014. Ontario Ministry of Education Professional Learning Supports, 8:56. https://vimeo.com/showcase/10065992/video/88186018.

- National Council of Teachers of English (NCTE). "Formative Assessment That Truly Informs Instruction. Position Statements." October 21, 2013. https://ncte.org/statement/formative-assessment/.

- Nunavut Department of Education. *Ilitaunnikuliriniq: Foundation for Dynamic Assessment as Learning in Nunavut Schools*. 2008.

- Ontario Ministry of Education, Student Achievement Division. *Pedagogical Documentation Revisited: Looking at Assessment and Learning in New Ways*. 2015. https://drive.google.com/file/d/1c2PbIs43HCViwCW7qXrkZqWjDkTl6r3e/view.

- Tarr, Pat. "Curiosity, Curriculum and Collaboration Entwined: Reflections on Pedagogical Documentation." *Canadian Children* 35, no. 2 (Fall 2010), 10–14. https://misalondon.ca/PDF/BIP/SupportMaterials/Curiosity_Curriculum_And_Collaboration_Entwined.pdf.

CONSIDERATIONS FOR CURRICULUM IMPLEMENTATION

This section explores important aspects of curriculum implementation in Nunavut that should be considered in order to create a culturally responsive learning environment. It explores ways to honour Inuit values, languages, identity, and traditions and foster student engagement and success. Effective curriculum implementation will involve not only educators and administrators but also support staff, community members, and families. All stakeholders can contribute to the success of the made-in-Nunavut curriculum and work collaboratively to address any challenges or concerns that may arise.

GUIDING QUESTION
What part can you play in helping to support successful implementation?

Language of instruction

Section 23 of the *Education Act* (2008) states that: "Every student every student shall be given a bilingual education and the [languages of instruction] shall be the Inuit language and either English or French as determined by a District Education Authority with respect to the schools under its jurisdiction."[13]

The term *language of instruction* (*LOI*) is used to identify the percentage of instruction a student may receive in a certain language over the length of an academic year. The term is used in reference to Nunavut's bilingual education models (also referred to as LOI models) that DEAs choose to follow in the delivery of the education program. The three LOI delivery models currently used in Nunavut schools are described below:

- The **Qulliq Model** meets the needs of Nunavut communities in which Inuktut is the first language. This model supports Inuktut as the initial LOI in most subject areas to build learners' strength and confidence in Inuktut while gradually introducing subjects taught in English.

- The **Immersion Model** was developed for communities that have experienced significant language loss. The focus of this model is to reverse language loss and produce strong bilingual graduates. In this model, most of the subjects are taught in Inuktut (as you would see in French immersion programs in southern Canada) while gradually adding subjects taught in English.

- The **Dual Model** is designed for communities that have a large base of both strong Inuktut first-language speakers and English first-language speakers. It integrates Inuktut and English speakers into schools by providing an Inuit Language Stream, in which most subjects are initially taught in Inuktut while gradually introducing subjects taught in English, as well as a Non-Inuit Language Stream, in which most subjects are initially taught in English while gradually introducing subjects taught in Inuktut. This approach enables each group of students to learn in their first language while also ensuring that students graduate with proficiency in both Inuktut and English.

Each LOI model requires a specific language arts first-language and second-language curriculum. Additionally, other subject areas must be delivered in Inuktut or English to fulfill the LOI time allocations and percentage requirements identified for each model.

The made-in-Nunavut curriculum has been designed to be delivered in Inuktut or English as needed to maintain equity and consistency across the territory. It also aims to be inclusive of students' first language and dialects and to celebrate the linguistic diversity across Nunavut. Additional supports and resources will continue to be developed to support learning across all LOI models while continuing to centre Inuit language and culture and reflect life in Nunavut.

Inclusive language and preservation of dialects

The made-in-Nunavut curriculum recognizes the importance of inclusive language practices and the preservation of diverse dialects. By embracing and valuing students' first languages and dialects, educators and administrators can create an educational environment that fosters linguistic diversity, cultural pride, and academic success. This section provides guidance on how to promote inclusive language practices in the classroom and the school community. It also provides guidance on how to empower students to embrace their linguistic heritage while they develop proficiency in multiple languages.

Incorporating students' first language and dialects

To promote inclusive language practices, teachers in all LOI models are encouraged to incorporate students' first language and dialects actively into classroom activities, discussions, and assessments. While curriculum and supporting materials in Inuktut will be written using the Educational Standard for language, all dialects should be incorporated. By acknowledging and utilizing students' linguistic strengths, teachers can create a supportive learning environment that values their diverse language backgrounds. Educators should provide opportunities for students to use their first languages and dialects during class discussions, presentations, and group work. They should also emphasize the importance of bilingualism and biliteracy, recognizing that students can benefit academically and culturally by maintaining proficiency in multiple languages.

Valuing linguistic diversity

Creating an environment that values and respects all languages and dialects is essential for inclusive education. When students feel their language skills are valued, they develop a stronger sense of identity, confidence, and connection to their cultural heritage. Educators should foster an inclusive classroom atmosphere by celebrating and respecting the linguistic diversity of students. They can also encourage students to share stories, songs, or cultural traditions in their first languages and display multilingual posters, labels, and materials in the classroom in the different languages and dialects used by their students.

Collaborating with the community

Engaging with the local community and Elders is crucial for ensuring that language revitalization efforts align with community needs and aspirations. By working collaboratively, schools can strengthen the cultural significance of dialects and promote a sense of pride and ownership among students. Schools can actively seek input and collaboration from community members and Elders to incorporate cultural perspectives and linguistic practices into the learning experiences and involve them in language-related activities, guest speaking, or cultural events to enhance students' understanding of, and appreciation for, their languages and dialects.

Professional development and support

Engaging in professional development opportunities and making use of support resources are vital to implementing inclusive language practices in the classroom effectively. Educators should be equipped with the knowledge and strategies necessary to create a language-rich environment and support students' language development. Workshops, training sessions, and resources that focus on inclusive language practices, language acquisition strategies, and cultural competency can help prepare educators to create a learning environment that values language diversity. This also includes ongoing support and mentoring for new or untrained teachers to help them navigate the challenges related to inclusive language and dialects.

GUIDING QUESTION

What LOI model is used in your school? What types of language supports and resources would help your students participate fully in activities and learning experiences across subject areas?

Cross-curricular and inquiry-based approaches to teaching and learning

Cross-curricular and inquiry-based approaches to teaching and learning are widely recognized as best practices in education. These approaches offer powerful tools to engage students in meaningful learning experiences, foster critical thinking skills, and promote the integration of knowledge across subject areas. In the context of education in Nunavut, these approaches align with the IQ principles and the goal of providing a holistic and culturally responsive education. The structure of the made-in-Nunavut curriculum supports the integration of learning across Curriculum Foundations and subject areas as well as the integration of learning around the IQ principles or common Major Understandings or Guiding Questions.

Cross-curricular approaches involve intentionally integrating multiple subject areas to explore a common theme, topic, or concept. Rather than treating subjects as separate and disconnected, cross-curricular teaching aims to highlight the interconnectedness of knowledge and encourage students to make connections across disciplines. This approach encourages students to see the relevance and applicability of their learning beyond individual subject areas.

Inquiry-based approaches emphasize student-led investigations and active participation in the learning process. In an inquiry-based classroom, students are encouraged to ask questions, explore ideas, conduct research, and seek solutions to real-world problems. This approach nurtures curiosity, critical thinking, and problem-solving skills while promoting student ownership and engagement.

Cross-curricular and inquiry-based approaches resonate with the educational values and principles of Nunavut. By integrating knowledge from various subject areas, cross-curricular teaching aligns with the holistic view of learning, which is central to IQ. It recognizes that knowledge is interconnected and that understanding a concept requires exploring its various dimensions.

Inquiry-based learning aligns with the Inuit tradition of active learning through observation, reflection, and engagement with the environment. It fosters the exploration of real-world issues, promoting students' connection to their community, culture, and environment. Inquiry-based approaches also provide opportunities for students to apply IQ principles, such as teamwork, respect, collaboration, and innovation, in their learning process.

Implementing cross-curricular and inquiry-based approaches requires intentional planning and collaboration among educators. Here are some practical strategies for integrating these approaches into the classroom:

- **Thematic units:** Design interdisciplinary units centring a theme or concept that incorporates relevant Learning Outcomes from different subjects. For example, exploring the theme of sustainability could involve elements of science, social studies, and language arts. The *Nunavut K-6 Teacher Planning Guide* is a great resource to use for thematic planning.

- **Project-based learning:** Engage students in hands-on projects that involve research, problem-solving, and collaboration. Encourage them to investigate real-world issues and develop solutions using a cross-curricular lens. Project-based learning can incorporate a variety of knowledge, skills, and understandings from across subject areas. For example, a community helpers project could integrate physical education, health and wellness, social studies, language arts, and arts education.

- **Authentic assessments:** Implement assessments that reflect real-world applications of knowledge and skills. This can include presentations, exhibitions, portfolios, or community-based projects that demonstrate student understanding across multiple subject areas. For example, as an assessment of learning in physical education, health, and wellness, students could develop presentations or resources to share important information about health and hygiene practices with younger students.

- **Community partnerships:** Foster partnerships with local organizations, Elders, and community members to provide authentic learning experiences. Invite guest speakers, organize field trips, or engage in service-learning projects that connect students to their community and culture.

Inuuqatigiit: The Curriculum from the Inuit Perspective contains important information about Inuit culture and history as well as essential knowledge from Elders. Educators are encouraged to use *Inuuqatigiit* alongside the made-in-Nunavut curriculum to help them integrate cross-curricular and inquiry-based approaches that are culturally relevant and appropriate for students in Nunavut.

GUIDING QUESTION

How can planning for cross-curricular or inquiry-based learning support a holistic approach to education? What role does the curriculum play in planning for cross-curricular or inquiry-based learning?

Culturally responsive teaching and learning

Culturally responsive teaching is a student-centred approach to teaching and learning that recognizes and values the knowledge and experiences that each student brings to the classroom. Rather than being the keepers of knowledge, educators are the facilitators of learning and guide students in the learning process. *Atausiunngittumut Uqausirmut: Foundation for Languages of Instruction in Nunavut Schools* notes that successful teachers in Nunavut take a genuine interest in learning about the lives of their students outside of the classroom.[14] This section will outline different strategies and approaches educators can use with the made-in-Nunavut curriculum to create a learning environment that recognizes and responds to the strengths, needs, interests, and lived experiences of the students in the classroom.

Land-based education

"For Inuit, being on the land can be the ethical space between Inuit communities and the education system, with Inuit children at the centre of that space so that new equitable learning opportunities are created. New opportunities can manifest as new curriculum, new outcomes, new understandings about teaching and learning, new ways of working together."[15]
The Kindergarten–Grade 6 made-in-Nunavut curriculum recognizes land-based education as an integral part of teaching and learning in Nunavut. Land-based learning encompasses the IQ principles and recognizes the deep spiritual, physical, and mental connections that Inuit have to the land and the passing of knowledge from Elders and other knowledge holders to students. It values teaching the history of the land, using local language, and interacting with the outdoor environment. When students learn on the land, they can connect and interweave their understandings of nature, contemporary science, traditional knowledge, and daily life while developing a sense of place.

"The 'curriculum as planned' gives way to a 'curriculum as lived' as the land becomes both the classroom and instructor."[16]

The Kindergarten–Grade 6 made-in-Nunavut curriculum often refers to the land and learning on the land. The Learning Outcomes contain indicators of students demonstrating their learning, often with land-based examples, and recognize that a connection to the land is essential for student well-being. Inuit students' connection to the land is inseparable from their connection to daily life and their world, and the curriculum works to honour that understanding across subject areas.

Community connections

The *Inuit Qaujimajatuqangit Education Framework for Nunavut Curriculum* states that schooling in Nunavut should prepare students to "become well-equipped to contribute and serve their families and communities, demonstrate leadership and healthy attitudes, and be able to actively participate and contribute as Nunavut takes on new roles in the global community."[17] For students to do this, they must connect what they are learning in the classroom to their community. Their learning must show them how to respect themselves and others, appreciate families and communities working together, and explore traditions, knowledge, skills, and beliefs that Inuit have used to survive.[18] When students learn from Elders, knowledge holders, and community members, they learn how to help contribute to the local and global community.

All subject areas in the made-in-Nunavut curriculum highlight the importance of incorporating local topics, events, and traditions in the classroom. Drawing on a variety of resources, including community knowledge holders, ensures that the learning environment is accessible and reflects the lives of the students and their community. Teaching and learning that centre authentic locally based topics and themes can help students see themselves reflected in the curriculum and understand how their learning applies to the world around them. When students see themselves in their learning, they can apply their knowledge and skills in different contexts to build deeper understandings and acquire new skills and abilities.

The *Innait Inuksiutilirijiit Handbook* from the Department of Education contains vital information for planning Elder visits in the school and classroom. The handbook guides educators on how to make sure that Elders' visits are a comfortable and pleasant experience for them and beneficial for students. Refer to this handbook when planning Elder visits in the school and classroom.

Local stories

Students feel connected to their learning when it reflects their families, communities, and experiences. Through local stories, students can connect to the past, present, and future. Students can use stories to consider the impact of their choices and the choices of people around them, and how to sustain, improve, or modify those choices in the future. Educators are encouraged to use local events, news, traditional stories, and histories to engage students using evidence and artifacts such as photos, articles, audio recordings, or videos. Current events show students real-life examples of what they are learning in the classroom and how they affect their daily lives (for example, oil spills, community festivals, and laws being passed).

GUIDING QUESTION

How does culturally responsive teaching serve the community and support collaboration among school staff, students, and families? What does culturally responsive teaching and learning look like in your classroom and your school?

Resources for further reading and viewing

- Canadian Commission UNESCO. "Land As Teacher: Understanding Indigenous Land-Based Education." June 21, 2021. https://en.ccunesco.ca/idealab/indigenous-land-based-education.

- M.K. Kaluraq, *Nunami Ilinniarniq: Inuit Community Control of Education through Land-Based Education* (Toronto: The Gordon Foundation, 2020): https://gordonfoundation.ca/resource/kaviq-kaluraq-policy-paper/.

- Kreuger, J. "The Nexus Between Aboriginal Program Development and Leadership: The Kivalliq Science Educators' Community." Transcript of presentation to the Council of Ministers of Education Forum on Aboriginal Education. Winnipeg: December 1–2, 2011. http://ksec.ca/wp-content/uploads/2015/03/Leadership-KSEC-CMEC.pdf.

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GUIDING QUESTION

Are there additional considerations for curriculum implementation? Where can you find additional supports or resources to help you implement the new curriculum?

KEY DOCUMENTS AND RESOURCES

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ENDNOTES

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